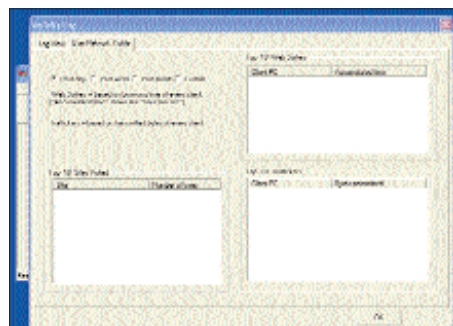


## SyGate Office Network

SyGate Office Network (SON) is one of the best network management software you'd come across. SON's mixture of features, as well as the simplicity of the interface, gets it our Best Value award. The software has features a system administrator would love, and it has more features than on any other software on the board.

The 'Disconnect Client If Idle' feature is particularly useful: the server keeps constant track of users, and if one of them is idle for a certain time, the connection is freed up for someone else to use. This indirectly helps reduce dial-up costs.

In the bandwidth management aspect, the enforcing system



Looking at the top three of the Top 10 is an excellent way to know who's using up bandwidth

provides creation of groups, each with different priorities for applications, such as e-mail, Web, Telnet, news-groups and so on. Groups can be created based on need, and priorities assigned according to requirements.

Backup Internet provision is yet another useful feature. If, for some reason, your broadband connection fails, the software switches to the dial-up connection, thus providing service with as little interruption as possible. In a similar feature, the software dials the backup connection if traffic exceeds a threshold. This feature is important for people who need up-to-the minute information.

The software supports client installation, and you can also create a client-install floppy. However, client configuration is limited to setting the gateway IP to that of the server.

Coming to security, you can install SyGate Personal Firewall (SPF) with SON for free. SPF features Access Rules functionality, by which you can enforce restrictions: you can add any or all of the 40 rules defined, ranging from FTP, to access to games such as *Quake*, and access to IM programs. You can also custom-define rules.

The activity log is the best across the board, with real-time monitoring and a history viewer in addition to auditing. The auditing feature provides lists such as top 10 Web surfers, top 10 traffic users and top 10 sites visited. The activity log is the best we've seen, with real-time monitoring and a history viewer, in addition to auditing. The auditing feature provides lists such as top 10 Web surfers, top 10 traffic users and top 10 sites visited.

With a range of abilities such as disconnecting idle clients, provision for a backup Internet connection, bandwidth management, etc., this is a true professional network management software.

- + Great features
- No caching; no proxy cascading

Price: \$199.95

Web site: <http://smb.sygate.com/products/son.htm>

### SyGate Office Network **B+**

|             |            |
|-------------|------------|
| Performance | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Features    | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Ease of Use | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Overall     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |

get more

